



Low Contact for Co-Parents

Protecting your recovery while you raise kids together

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If you share children with your ex, full no contact isn't realistic or fair to the kids. What you can do is "low contact": communicate only about the children and logistics, in a calm, predictable, business-like way. It protects both your recovery and your children's stability.

The ground rules

- Talk about the children, schedules and money. Nothing personal.
- Use writing where possible (text, email or a co-parenting app) so there's a record and less emotion.
- Reply within a reasonable time, not instantly.
- Keep messages short: facts, requests, confirmations.
- Never use the children as messengers.

Message templates

- "Pickup Friday at 5pm at school. Confirming?"
- "School trip form attached, \$20 due Monday. I've paid; please send half when you can."
- "I can't do Sunday. Could we swap to Saturday 10am?"

Handovers

Keep handovers short and warm for the kids' sake. A consistent place and time helps. If face-to-face handovers are tense, school or daycare pickups can mean you rarely need to meet. After a difficult handover, give yourself a few minutes before your next task, and write down what came up later.

When they try to make it personal

If your ex brings up the relationship, don't engage. Redirect: "I'd like to keep our conversations about the kids. Is Saturday still okay?" Repeat as needed. You don't have to win the argument; you just don't have the argument.

Look after yourself between contacts

Low contact still means regular reminders of your ex, so the rest of your recovery matters even more: support from friends, sleep, and somewhere to put the feelings that come up after

each exchange.

Safety

If there's abuse, threats or safety concerns, get specialist advice about arrangements and communication. In the US, the National Domestic Violence Hotline is 1-800-799-7233.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

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